

**BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE
DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE INSTRUCTION 36-9999
24 MARCH 2026**

PERSONNEL

AIR FORCE FELINE DOMESTIC COMPANIONSHIP & READINESS PROGRAM

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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This instruction implements DAFPD 36-99, Domestic Animal Standards. It establishes directive guidance for the ownership, care, billeting, and morale integration of domestic felines (*Felis catus*) across all Department of the Air Force installations, including Regular Air Force, Space Force, Air Force Reserve, and Air National Guard.

CHAPTER 1 - GENERAL FELINE READINESS STANDARDS

- 1.1. Program Intent. Domestic felines provide critical emotional support, morale enhancement, and pest deterrence for Airmen and Guardians. When properly maintained, felines contribute directly to operational readiness.
- 1.2. Authorized Breeds and Markings. Airmen may possess domestic short-hair, long-hair, calico, tuxedo, and tabby felines. Orange tabby felines suspected of operating with a single shared brain cell require no special medical waiver, provided they maintain conservative behavior in public areas.
- 1.3. Registration and Microchipping. All felines residing on military installations must be registered with the Base Veterinary Treatment Facility (VTF) within 14 calendar days of arrival. Mandatory vaccinations include rabies, feline distemper, and feline leukemia. Microchipping is mandatory for all felines (T-1).
- 1.4. Mandatory Sleep Allocation. In accordance with feline physiological requirements, all authorized felines must be afforded no less than 16 to 18 hours of uninterrupted sleep per 24-hour cycle. Waking a sleeping cat for non-emergency duty requires Squadron Commander authorization.

DAFI 36-9999 (PAGE 2) - BASE HOUSING & DORMITORIES

CHAPTER 2 - BILLETING, DORMS, AND NOISE ABATEMENT

2.1. Maximum Authorized Feline Density. In unaccompanied Airman dormitories, members in the grade of E-4 and above with dorm pet authorization may maintain a maximum of one (1) feline per room. Family base housing units are authorized a maximum of three (3) felines without an approved Wing Commander waiver.

2.2. Midnight Zoomies and Quiet Hours. Felines must observe installation quiet hours between 2200L and 0600L. The phenomenon known as 'The 0300 Midnight Zoomies'—defined as unprovoked, high-velocity sprints across furniture and occupants—will be mitigated by evening feather-wand exercise sessions. Repeat noise infractions will be referred to the First Sergeant.

2.3. Litter Box Readiness & First Sergeant Inspections. Litter boxes must be scooped daily and sanitized weekly. First Sergeants and Dorm Managers are authorized to conduct unannounced cleanliness inspections. An odor rating exceeding moderate ammoniac levels constitutes a health and wellness violation under Article 92, UCMJ.

2.4. Damage to Government Property. Airmen are financially liable for claw damage inflicted on government-furnished barracks furniture, door jambs, or curtains. Members must maintain cardboard scratching posts or sisal scratching poles in plain view. Laser pointer usage directly targeting government walls is strictly prohibited.

2.5. Food and Treat Discipline. Wet food will be administered on a standardized schedule. Felines vocalizing dramatically at 0500L as if they have never been fed in their entire natural lives does not constitute an official military emergency.

CHAPTER 3 - WORKPLACE INTEGRATION AND FLIGHTLINE RESTRICTIONS

- 3.1. Squadron Morale Felines (Shop Cats). Unit Commanders in the grade of Major (O-4) or civilian equivalent may designate an official 'Squadron Morale Cat'. Morale cats must possess an official AF Form 114 (Feline Duty Badge) and are authorized to nap in in-boxes, keyboards, and commander briefing chairs.
- 3.2. Uniform Wear & Cat Hair Allowances. Airmen wearing the OCP (Operational Camouflage Pattern) or Service Dress uniform will make reasonable efforts to de-shed using sticky lint rollers prior to official formations. Total cat hair surface area coverage on the uniform will not exceed 10% under normal duty conditions. Complete absence of cat hair is recognized as statistically impossible for feline owners.
- 3.3. Flightline Restrictions (FOD Hazard). Under no circumstances will felines be permitted inside the Controlled Movement Area (CMA), flightline, or aircraft hangars. Cats swatting at intake turbine blades or sitting on pitot tubes represent severe Foreign Object Debris (FOD) hazards. Violators will be impounded immediately.

Table 3.1. Feline Physical Fitness Readiness Assessment (PFRA) Standards

Component	Minimum Standard	Scoring Standard	Disqualification Factor
Daily Nap Time	16.0 Hours	Exceeds 20.0 Hours (100 pts)	Under 12.0 Hours (Fail)
Cardboard Box Entry	100% Fit Rate	If it fits, it sits (Go/No-Go)	Refusal to enter box
Laser Dot Tracking	30 Seconds	Vigorous tail swish	Ignoring the dot completely
Purr Decibel Rating	35 dB	Audible from 2 feet (100 pts)	Silent purr (Requires Retest)